

Two years later, he married Márta Ziegler, who was among his piano students and still a teenager. The pair soon had a son, also named Béla.

Meanwhile, his field research did not stop at the borders of Hungary. Over the years, he undertook many trips, visiting Turkey, the Middle East, and Algeria. The String Quartet No. 2 is one example of the results, incorporating elements from the Berber music he encountered in North Africa.

Bartók's settings of Hungarian texts reveal much about the influence of language itself upon his music. His opera Duke Bluebeard's Castle (1911) was steeped in the world of Symbolist poetry and set a libretto by Béla Balázs. The story, based on *La Barbe bleue* by French writer of fairy tales Charles Perrault tells of how Bluebeard's new wife makes shocking discoveries as she opens doors in his castle. The atmospheric work shows how closely Bartók's melodic lines follow the cadences of speech.